Customer Credit Control

Functional guide (user manual)

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Reading guide

Who are you?

You are…	What you do with this module	Read these chapters
Salesperson (group Sales / User)	Make quotations, see how much credit the customer has used this month, follow the monthly credit report	Overview, Steps 5, 6 and 9 of the Business cycle, Troubleshooting
Finance user (group Accounting / Invoicing)	Put a customer on the watch list for a dispute, and remove that flag	Step 12 of the Business cycle, Conditional behavior
Finance Manager (group Accounting / Administrator)	Set the monthly limits, approve orders over a limit, put customers on hold or block and release them	All chapters
Warehouse user (group Inventory / User)	Validate deliveries; meets the refusal for customers on hold	Step 10 of the Business cycle, Troubleshooting
Administrator (group Administration / Access Rights or higher)	Enter the company's ceiling and hold days	Steps 1 to 4 of the Business cycle

How to read this guide

Each step has a screenshot. The red numbers on a screenshot, like 1, match the same numbers in the text. Menu paths look like **Sales › Orders › Quotations**. Every chapter can be read on its own.

The screenshots come from a demonstration database with made-up customers (Demo Customer A, B, C and E), a ceiling of 500,000.00 SR and VAT at 15 %. They were taken by an administrator who has both the sales and the Finance Manager rights, so some buttons appear together that a normal user would see on separate screens. Some screens also show a pink banner and an **Approve Payment Term** button: they come from the separate Quotation Payment Terms module, not from this one.

Overview

What the module does

Customer Credit Control keeps sales on credit inside the company's credit policy, in two ways.

- **A monthly credit budget.** The company has a **Monthly Credit Ceiling**: the most it will sell on credit in one calendar month. Each customer has a **Monthly Credit Cap**, a percentage of that ceiling. When confirming an order would take the customer over its cap, or the company over its ceiling, the order is not confirmed. It waits until a Finance Manager approves it, with a reason.
- **A credit state per customer.** Each customer is Normal, on the Watch List, on Credit Hold or under Absolute Block. A check that runs every night moves customers with overdue invoices to the watch list, and to credit hold once an invoice is more than the company's hold days late (60 by default). Finance can also change the state by hand, always with a reason.

What each state stops:

Credit state	Quotations	Confirm orders	Validate deliveries	Post customer invoices
Normal	allowed	allowed	allowed	allowed
Watch List	allowed	allowed	allowed	allowed
Credit Hold	allowed	**refused**	**refused**	allowed
Absolute Block	**refused**	**refused**	**refused**	**refused**

Once a week, the Finance Managers receive an email listing the customers on the watch list or on hold, largest overdue amount first.

The problem it solves

Without the module, a salesperson can confirm one large credit order after another for the same customer, and Finance finds out at month end that the company has more money outstanding than it ever agreed to. Customers who stopped paying keep receiving goods, because nobody stops the next order or the next delivery. Credit decisions are made by phone and nobody can later say who agreed to what.

When to use it (and when not to)

Use it when the company sells on credit and wants a hard monthly limit per customer and for the company, with Finance in control of exceptions.

Orders on a payment term with **Advance (%)** at 100 are cash sales: they never count against the limits. If the company sells only against full advance payment, the monthly limits have nothing to do; the credit states still stop deliveries to customers with old unpaid invoices.

Business cycle

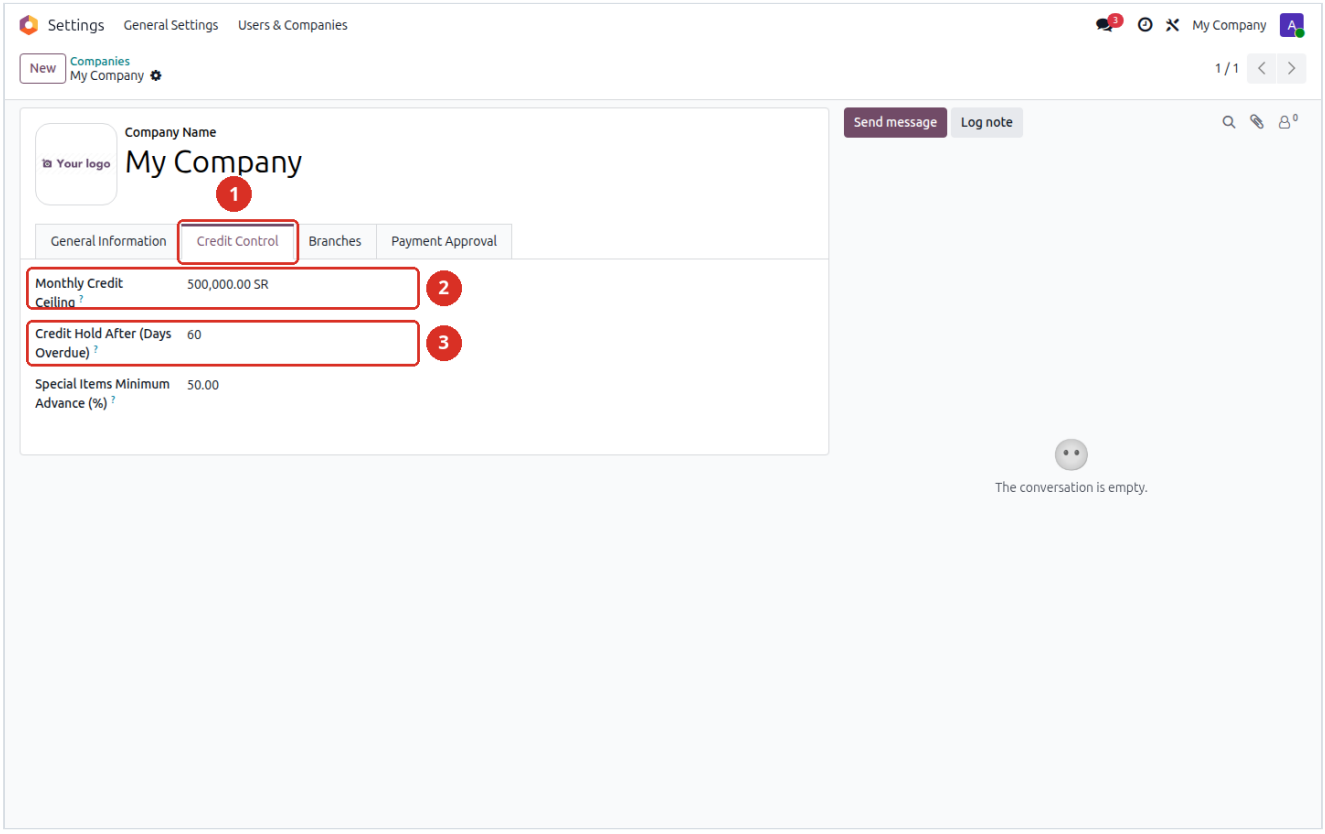
User stories

- As a **Finance Manager**, I want each customer's monthly credit to be capped, so that no single customer takes more credit than the policy allows.
- As a **Salesperson**, I want to see how much of the customer's monthly credit is already used while I prepare a quotation, so that I know before I confirm whether Finance must approve.
- As a **Finance Manager**, I want to approve an order over the limit with a reason, so that the exception is recorded on the order.
- As a **Finance Manager**, I want customers with old overdue invoices to be stopped automatically, and released only by me, so that we stop delivering to customers who do not pay.
- As a **Finance user**, I want to flag a customer with an open dispute, so that sales is warned before the problem grows.

Step 1: Set the company's ceiling and hold days

Who: an administrator who also has the Finance Manager right. Where:
Settings › Users & Companies › Companies, open the company.

1. Open the **Credit Control** tab 1.
2. Enter the **Monthly Credit Ceiling** 2: the most the company sells on credit in one calendar month, in the company currency. Leave 0 for no ceiling (then no order ever waits for approval).
3. Enter **Credit Hold After (Days Overdue)** 3: a customer goes on credit hold once any invoice is overdue by more than this number of days.
4. Save.



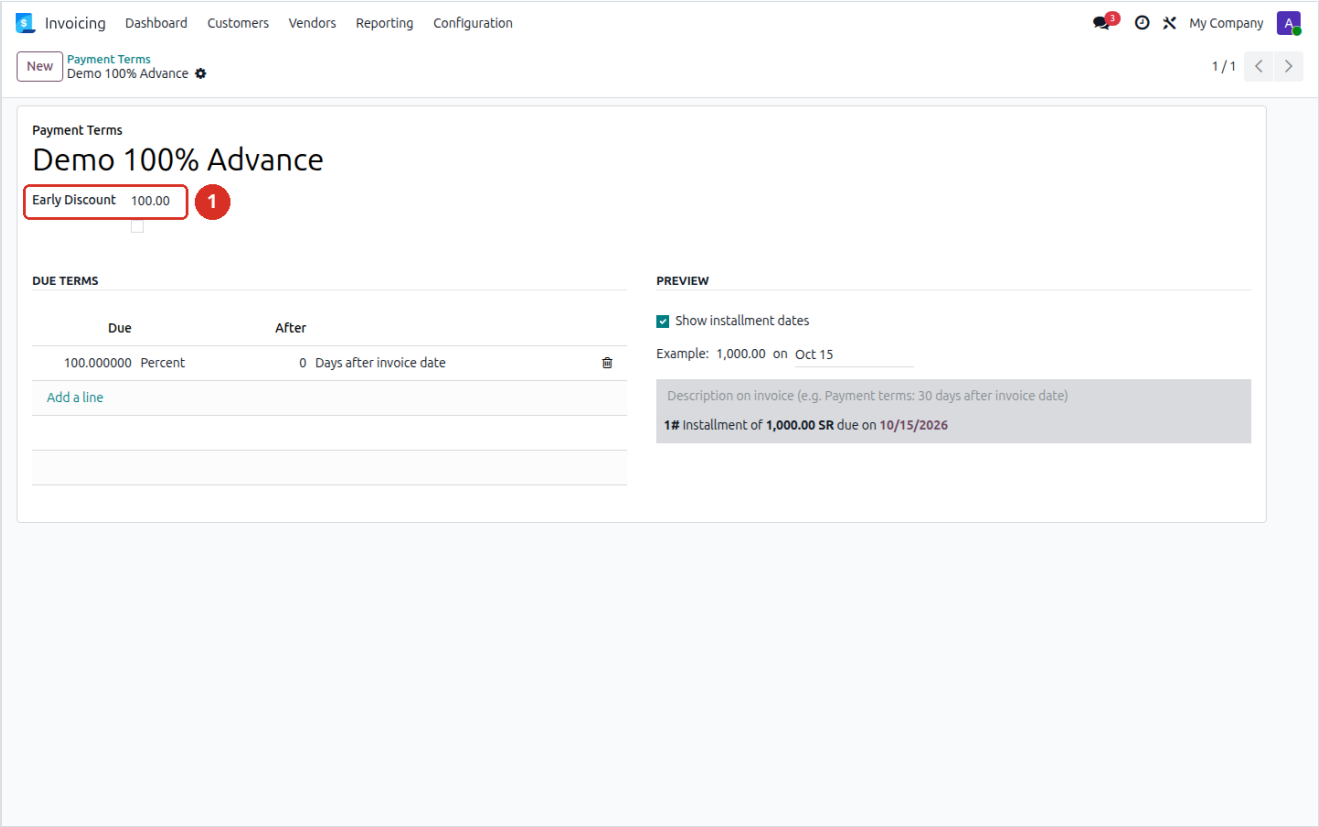
The company form, Credit Control tab: the tab 1, the monthly ceiling 2 and the hold days 3. The third field, Special Items Minimum Advance, belongs to the Quotation Payment Terms module.

> **Tip:** the tab is shown only to Finance Managers, and saving the company also needs the Administration / Access Rights right. A Finance Manager without it gets an access error when saving.

Step 2: Mark the cash (full advance) payment terms

Where: **Invoicing › Configuration › Invoicing › Payment Terms**.

Every payment term has an advance percentage, 0 by default. An order on a term at 100 % advance is paid in full before delivery and is not a credit sale. Open each cash term and enter 100 in the advance field 1, then save.



A payment term set to 100 % advance. The advance value 1 appears on the line labelled "Early Discount"; see the note below.

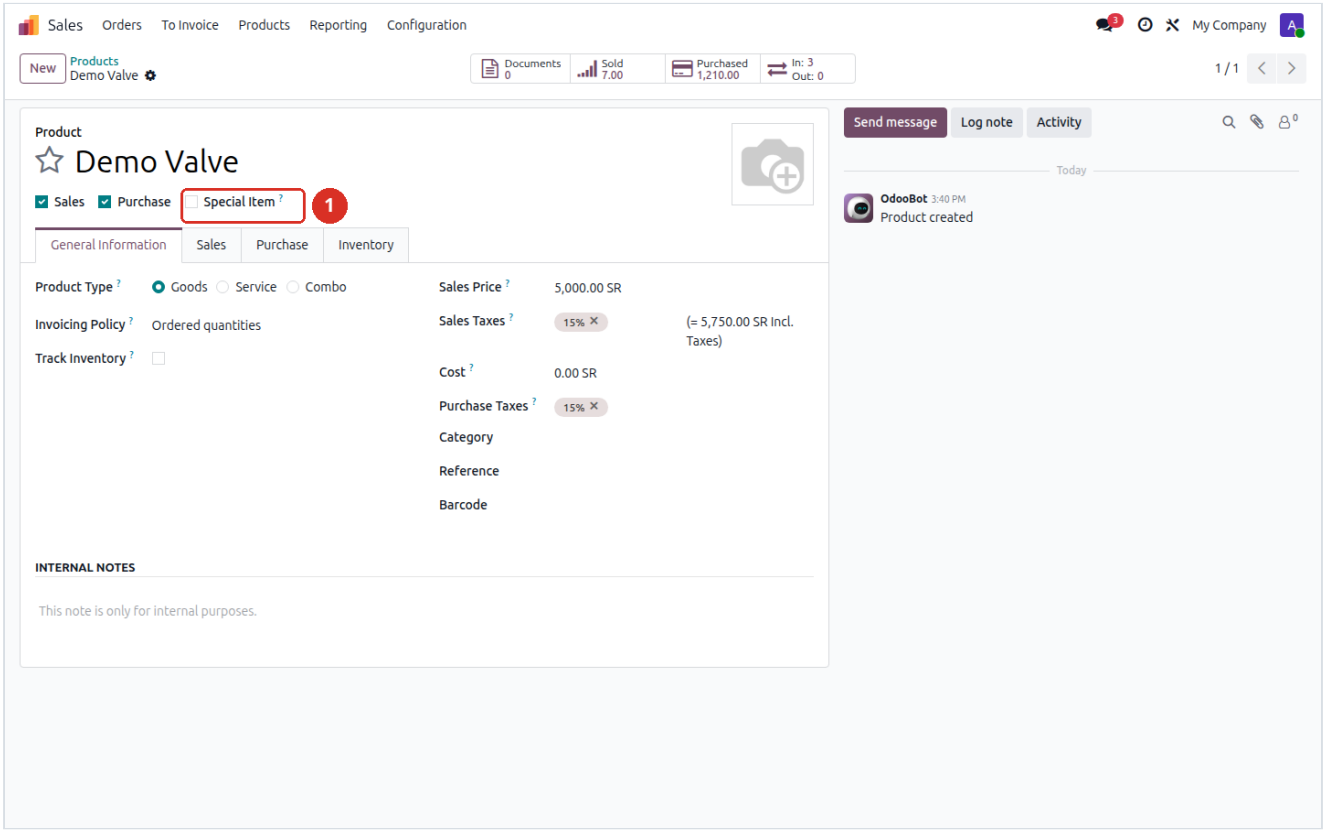
> **Note:** on this screen the new **Advance (%)** field has no label of its own: it is shown at the start of the **Early Discount** line 1, and the early discount check box moves under it. The number on that line is the advance percentage. This is a display fault reported to the development team (see Troubleshooting).

Step 3: Mark special products left out of credit totals

Where: **Sales › Products › Products**.

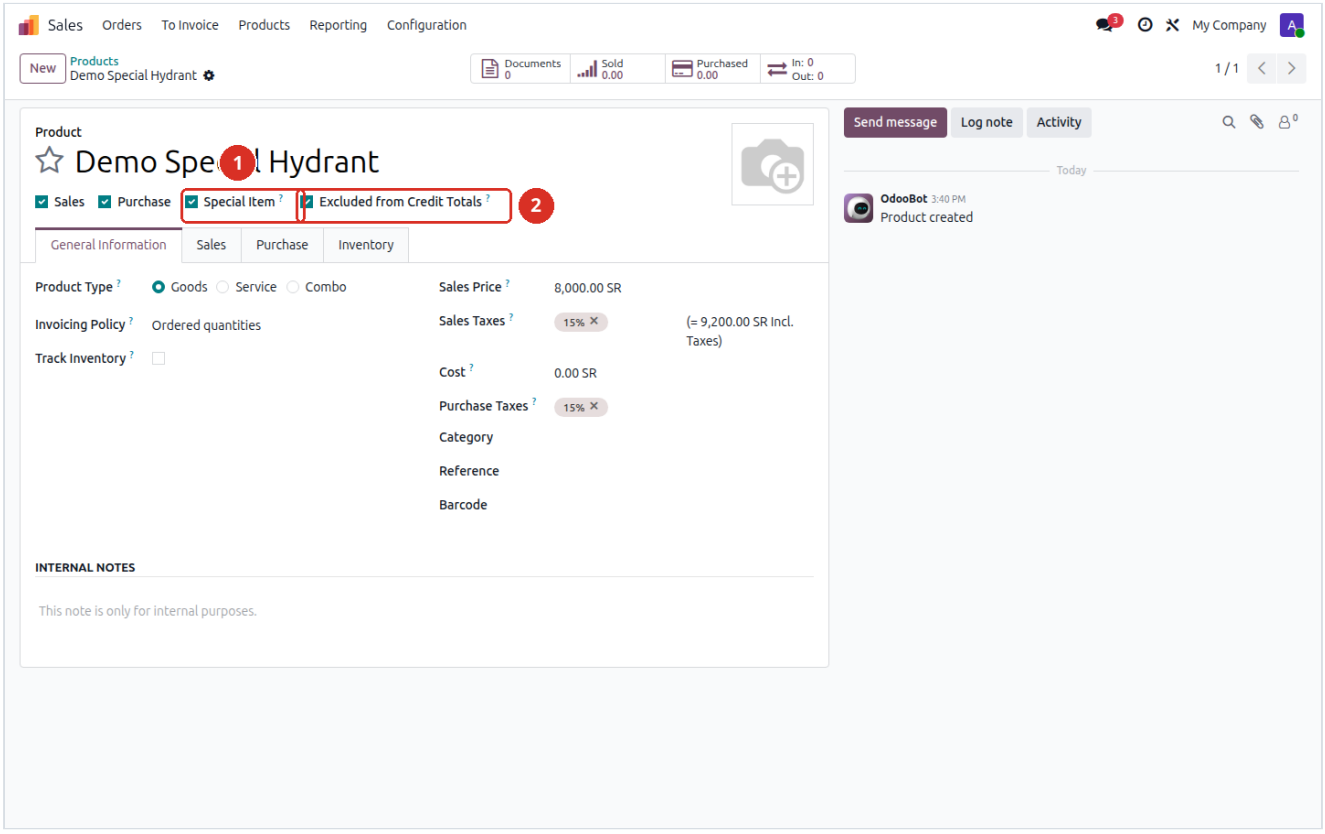
Some items can be left out of the monthly credit totals (for example items sold under a separate agreement). A product line is left out only when the product is both **Special Item** and **Excluded from Credit Totals**.

1. Tick **Special Item** 1 under the product name.



A normal product: only the Special Item box 1 is shown.

1. The box **Excluded from Credit Totals** 2 appears. Tick it too, then save.



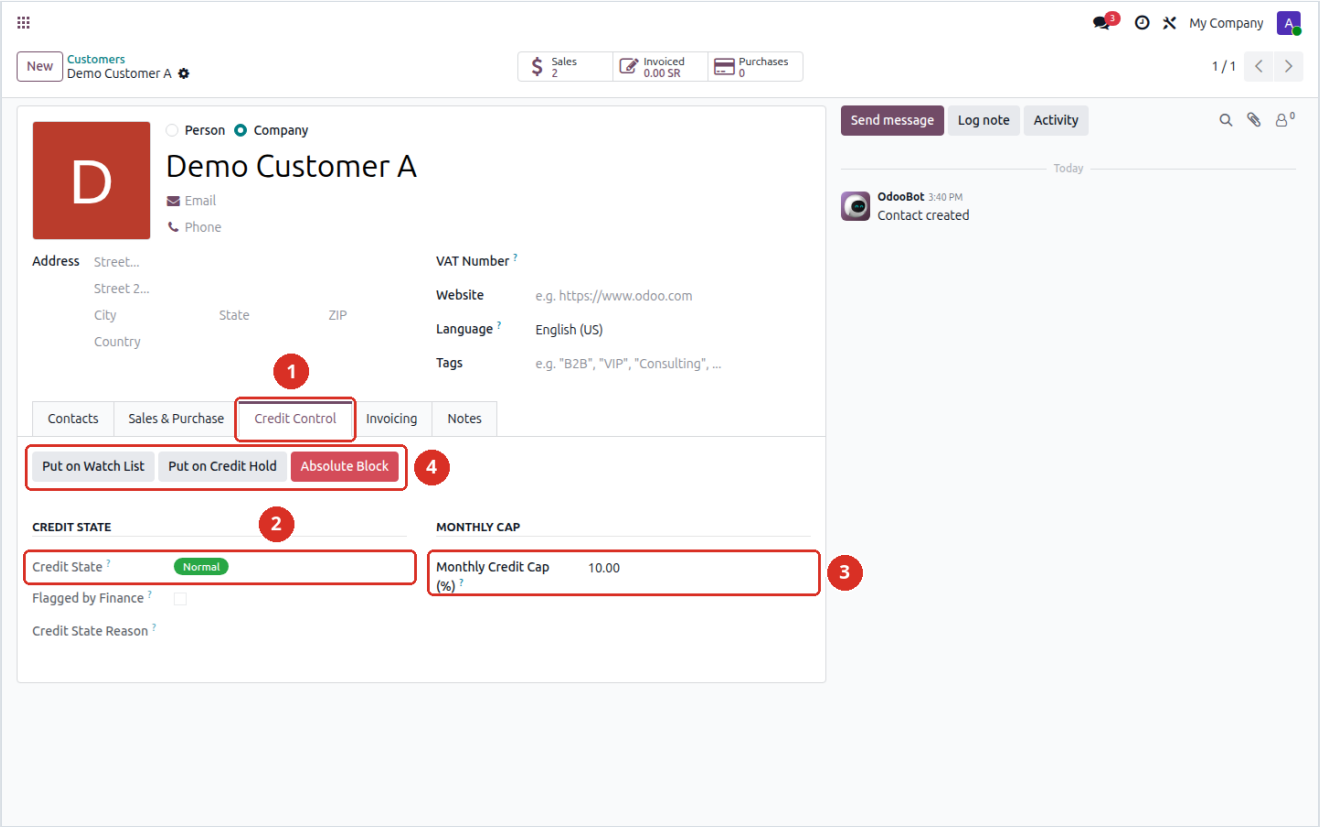
A special product left out of credit totals: Special Item 1 and Excluded from Credit Totals 2.

Step 4: Give each customer its monthly cap

Who: Finance Manager (see the tip below). Where: **Sales › Orders › Customers**, open the customer (the company, not one of its contact persons).

1. Open the **Credit Control** tab 1.
2. Check the **Credit State** 2. A new customer starts Normal.
3. Enter **Monthly Credit Cap (%)** 3: the share of the company's monthly ceiling this customer may use. With a ceiling of 500,000.00 SR, a cap of 10 means 50,000.00 SR per month. Leave 0 for no customer cap (the company ceiling still applies).
4. Save.

The buttons at the top of the tab 4 change the credit state; they are explained in Steps 10 to 13.



The customer's Credit Control tab: the tab 1, the credit state 2, the monthly cap 3 and the Finance buttons 4.

> **Tip:** the cap can only be changed by a Finance Manager, and saving the customer form also needs the right to edit contacts (for example Contacts / Creation or Sales / Administrator). A Finance Manager who has only the accounting right gets the message "You are not allowed to modify 'Contact' (res.partner) records."

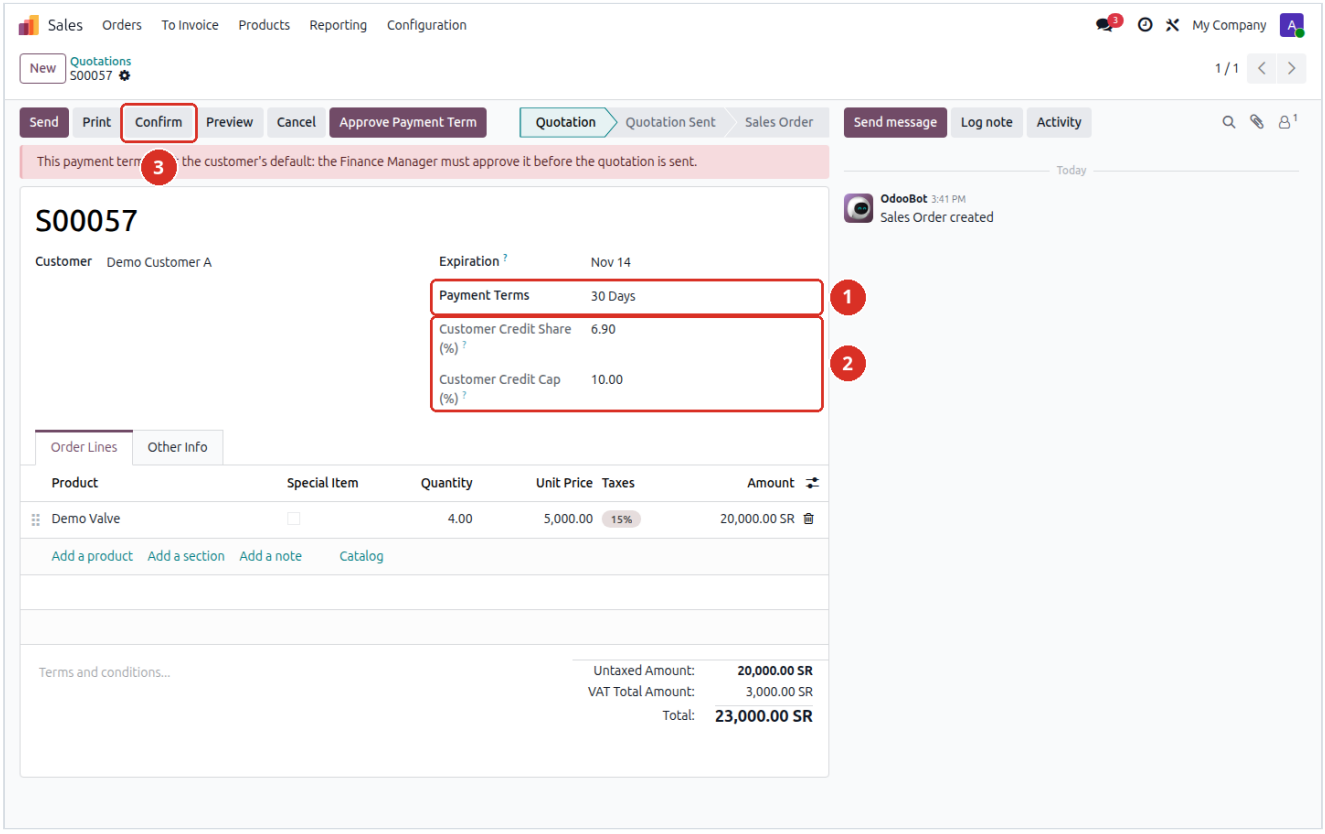
Step 5: Prepare the quotation and read the credit share

Who: Salesperson. Where: **Sales › Orders › Quotations**.

Create the quotation as usual. Next to the **Payment Terms** 1, two read-only fields 2 show:

- **Customer Credit Share (%)**: the credit the customer has already used this calendar month (confirmed credit orders, VAT included), as a share of the company ceiling;
- **Customer Credit Cap (%)**: the customer's cap.

In the example, Demo Customer A has used 6.90 % (34,500.00 SR) of a 10 % cap (50,000.00 SR). This new quotation is 23,000.00 SR, which would take the customer to 57,500.00 SR. Click **Confirm** 3.



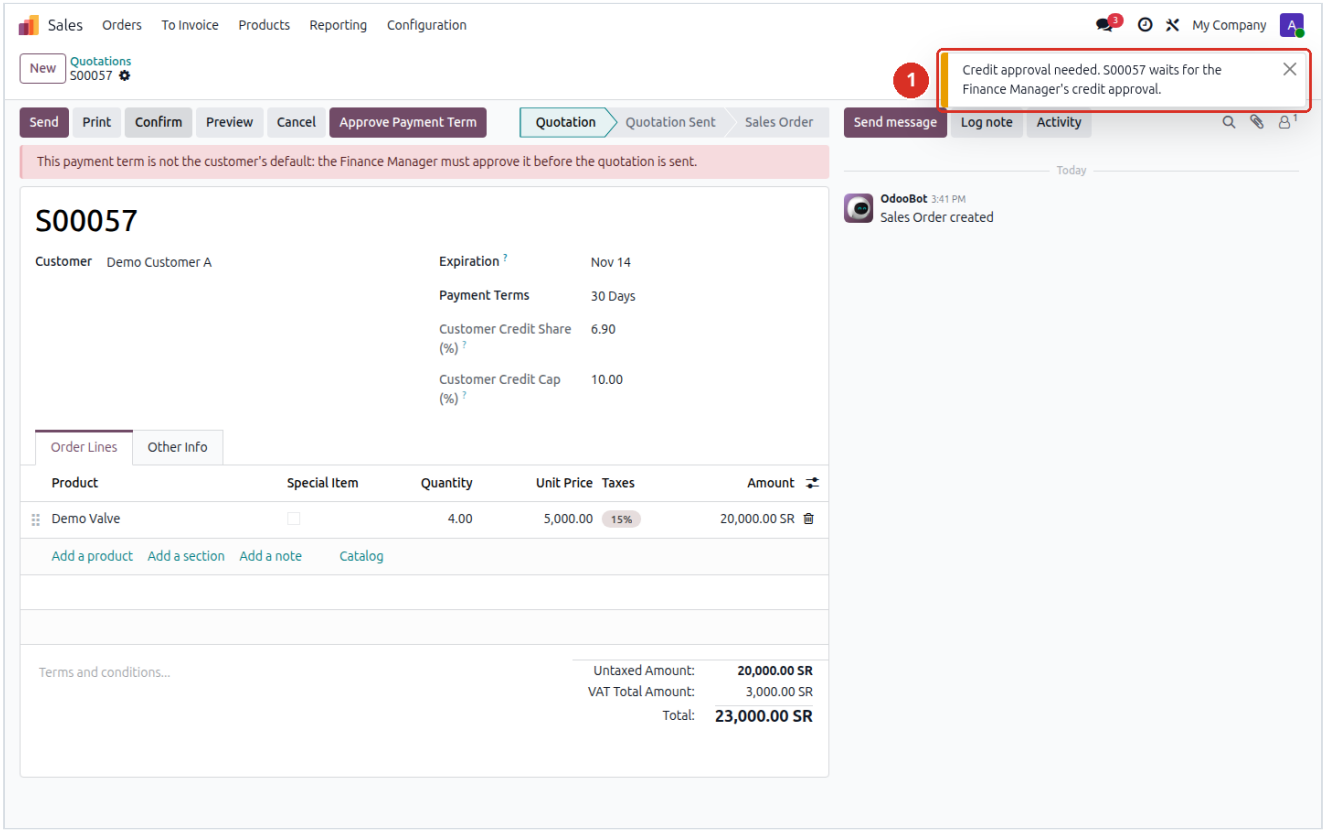
A quotation with the payment term 1, the customer's share and cap 2 and the Confirm button 3.

The share does not include the quotation you are looking at. Add the quotation total to the share yourself to know whether Finance will need to approve.

Step 6: The order waits for credit approval

When the order fits within the cap and the ceiling (exactly on the limit is allowed), it is confirmed as usual.

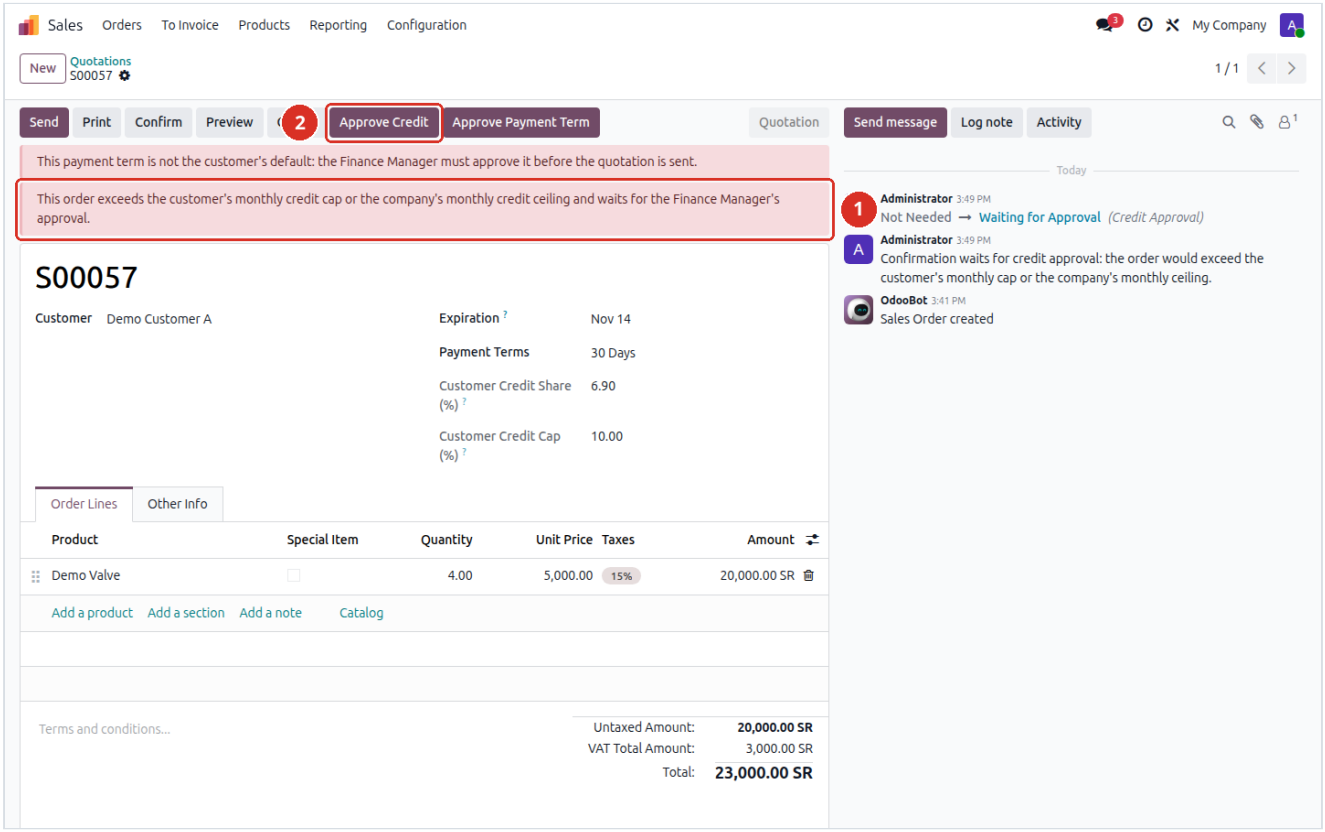
When it does not, Odoo does **not** confirm it. A warning appears at the top right 1: "Credit approval needed. S00057 waits for the Finance Manager's credit approval." The order stays a quotation.



The warning shown after Confirm 1. The order is still a quotation.

> **Tip:** the form does not refresh by itself after this warning. Reload the page (press F5) to see the red banner and the approval button.

After reloading, a red banner 1 says the order exceeds the customer's monthly cap or the company's monthly ceiling. The chatter (the message history on the right) records the change to Waiting for Approval. Finance Managers see the **Approve Credit** button 2; the salesperson does not.



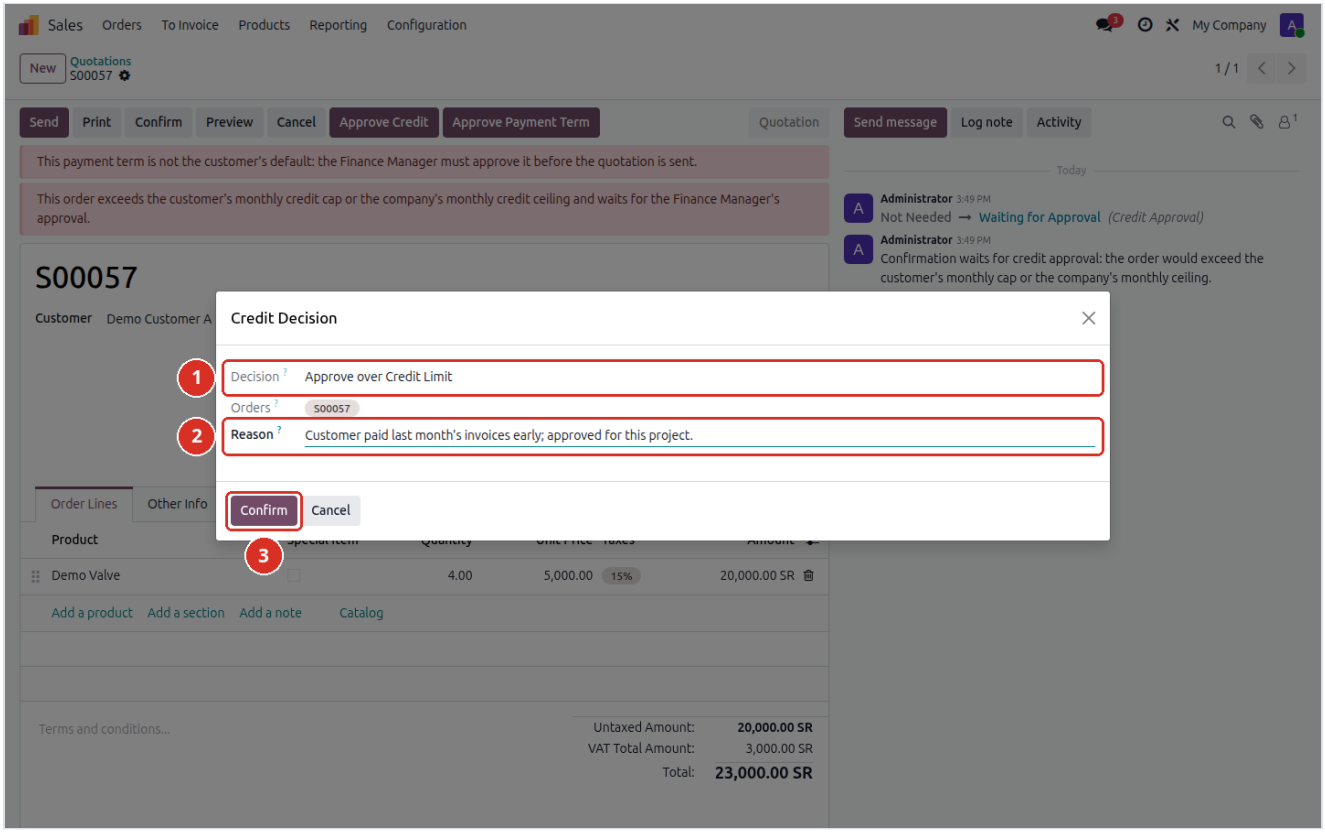
The waiting order after a reload: the red banner 1 and the Approve Credit button 2.

Tell the Finance Manager which order is waiting. The module does not send a notification to Finance for this.

Step 7: The Finance Manager approves the order

Who: Finance Manager. Where: open the waiting order from **Sales › Orders › Quotations**.

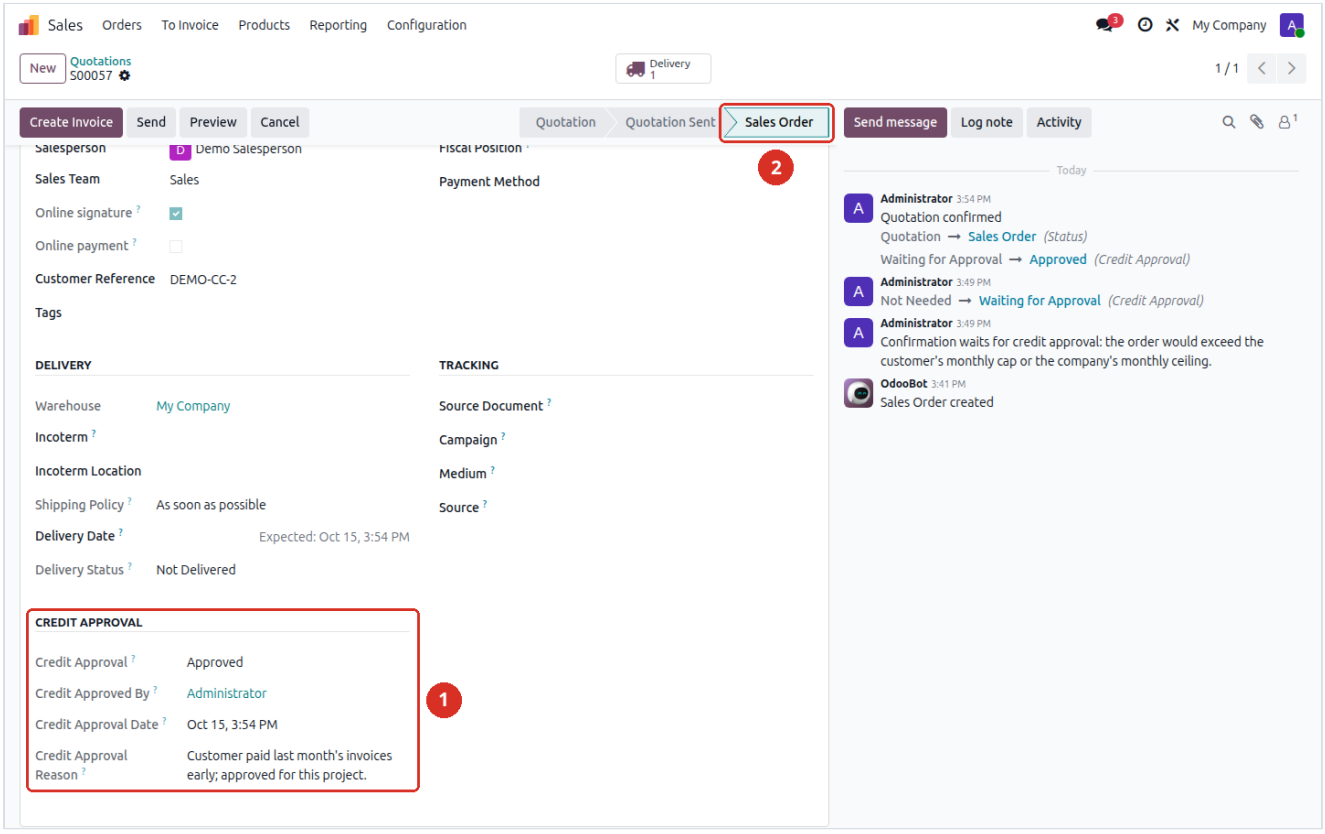
1. Click **Approve Credit**. A small window (a wizard) opens with the decision 1 already set to Approve over Credit Limit.
2. Type the **Reason** 2. It is required and is stored on the order.
3. Click **Confirm** 3.



The Credit Decision window: the decision 1, the reason 2 and Confirm 3.

Step 8: Check the approval on the order

The order is now a **Sales Order** 2. On the **Other Info** tab, the **Credit Approval** section 1 shows the approval, who approved, when and why. The chatter records the same.

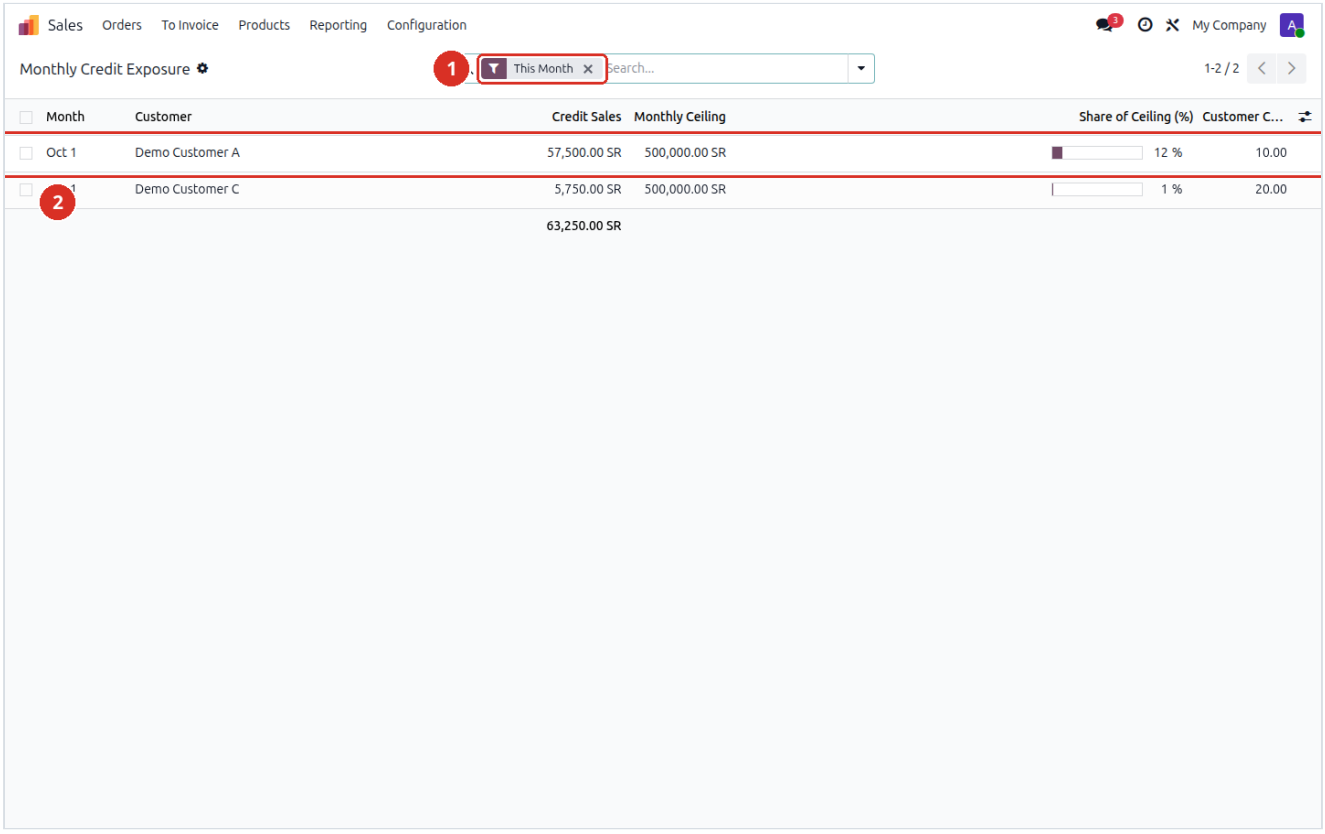


The confirmed order: the Credit Approval section 1 and the Sales Order status 2.

Step 9: Follow the month's credit sales

Who: Salesperson or Finance Manager. Where: **Sales › Reporting › Credit Exposure**.

The report opens on **This Month** 1. Each line is one customer 2: its credit sales of the month (VAT included), the company ceiling, the share of the ceiling as a bar, and the customer's cap. Lines appear only for customers with confirmed credit orders in the month. Demo Customer A now stands at 57,500.00 SR, 12 % (11.5 %) of the ceiling, above its 10 % cap because the Finance Manager approved the second order.



The Monthly Credit Exposure report: the This Month filter 1 and one customer's line 2.

> **Note:** the **Over Cap** filter of this report does not do what its name says: it lists every customer that has a cap, not only those above it. Compare **Share of Ceiling (%)** with **Customer Cap (%)** yourself until this is corrected.

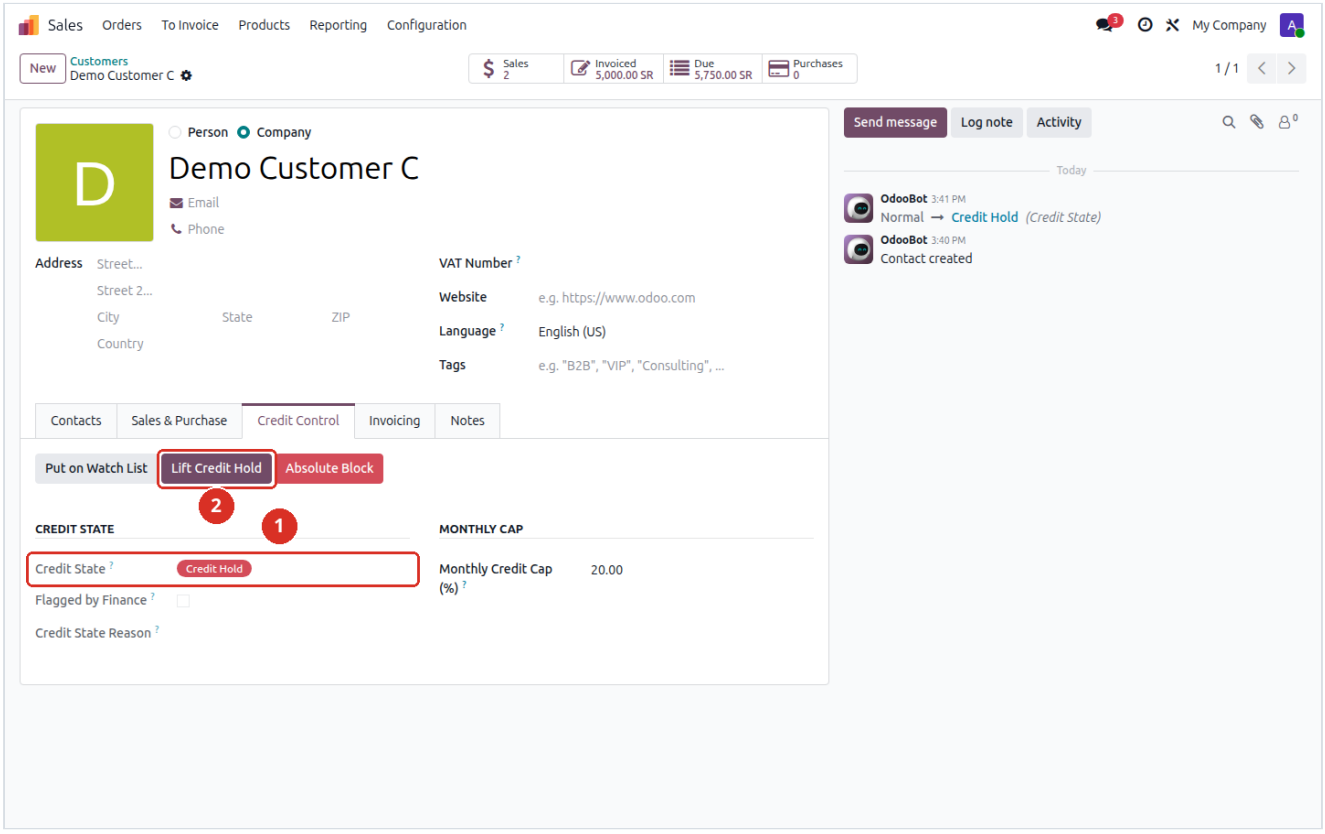
Step 10: A customer goes on credit hold

Every night, the module checks the open customer invoices:

- a customer with any invoice past its due date goes on the **Watch List**;
- a customer with an invoice overdue by more than the company's hold days goes on **Credit Hold**;
- a customer with nothing overdue and no Finance flag goes back to **Normal**.

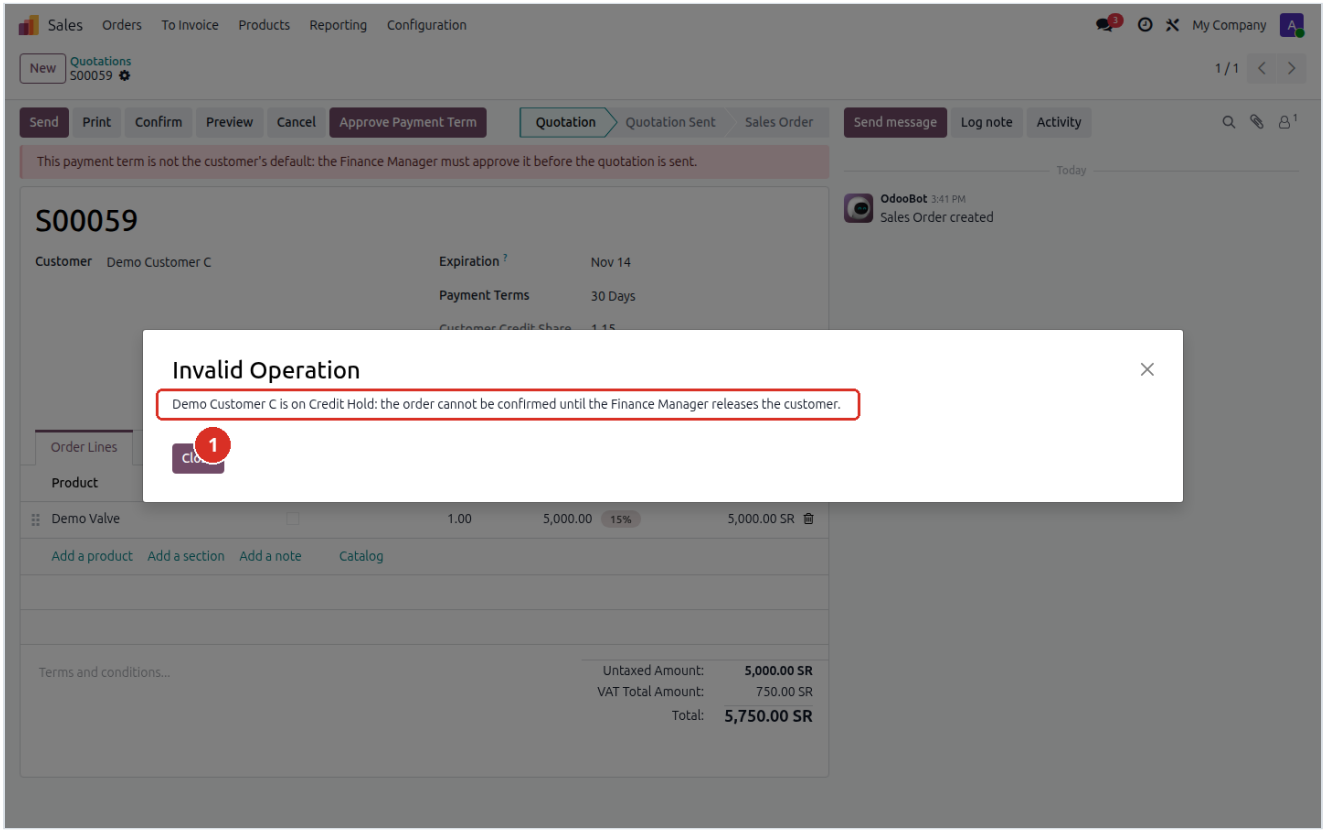
The nightly check never lifts a hold or a block; only the Finance Manager does. A Finance Manager can also click **Put on Credit Hold** on the customer's **Credit Control** tab at any time.

In the example, Demo Customer C has an invoice due on 1 August, 75 days overdue, so the nightly check put it on **Credit Hold** 1. The **Lift Credit Hold** button 2 appears.



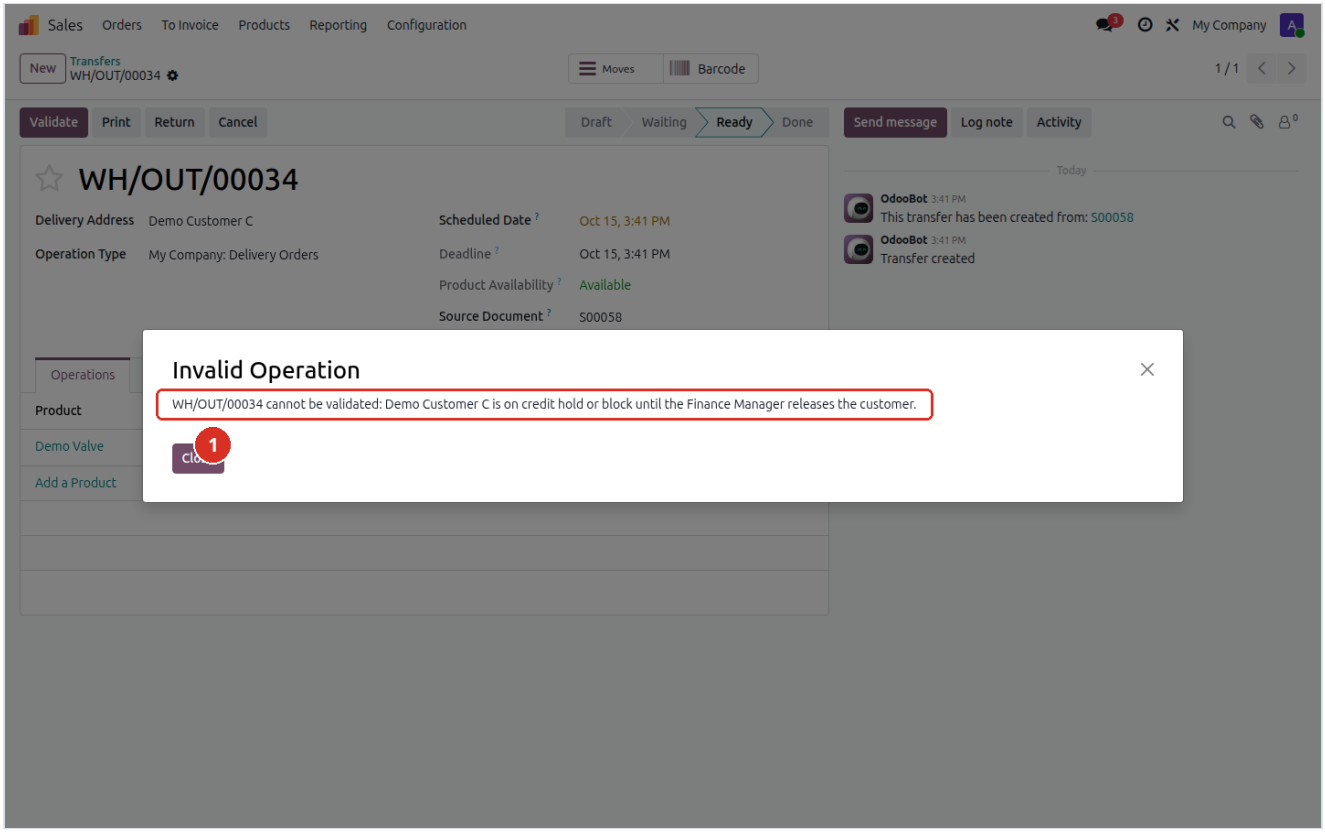
A customer on credit hold: the state 1 and the Lift Credit Hold button 2. The chatter shows the change made by the nightly check.

From now on, nobody can confirm an order for this customer 1:



Confirming a quotation for a customer on hold is refused 1.

Deliveries already planned are stopped too: the warehouse cannot validate them 1. Receipts and internal transfers are not affected.



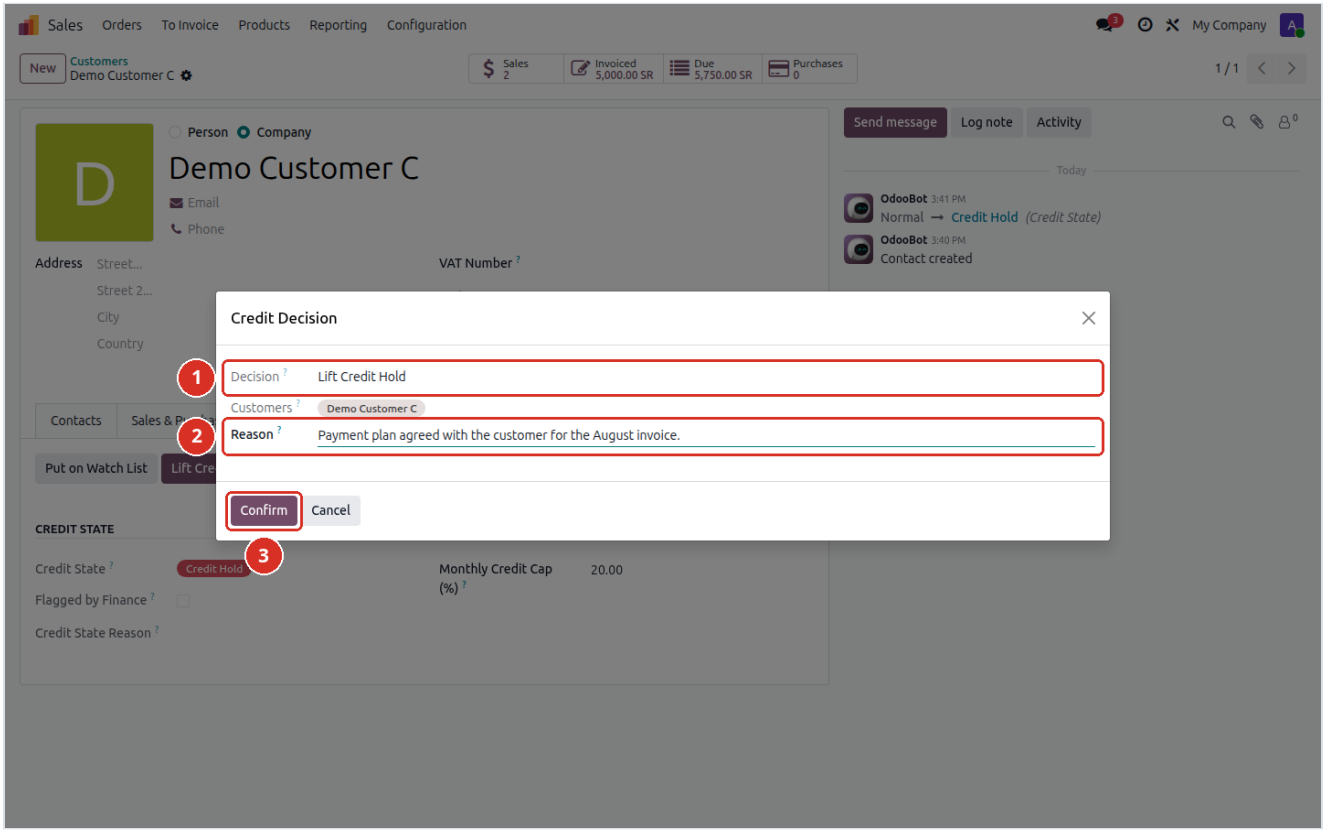
Validating a delivery for a customer on hold is refused 1.

Quotations can still be prepared and customer invoices can still be posted for a customer on hold.

Step 11: The Finance Manager lifts the hold

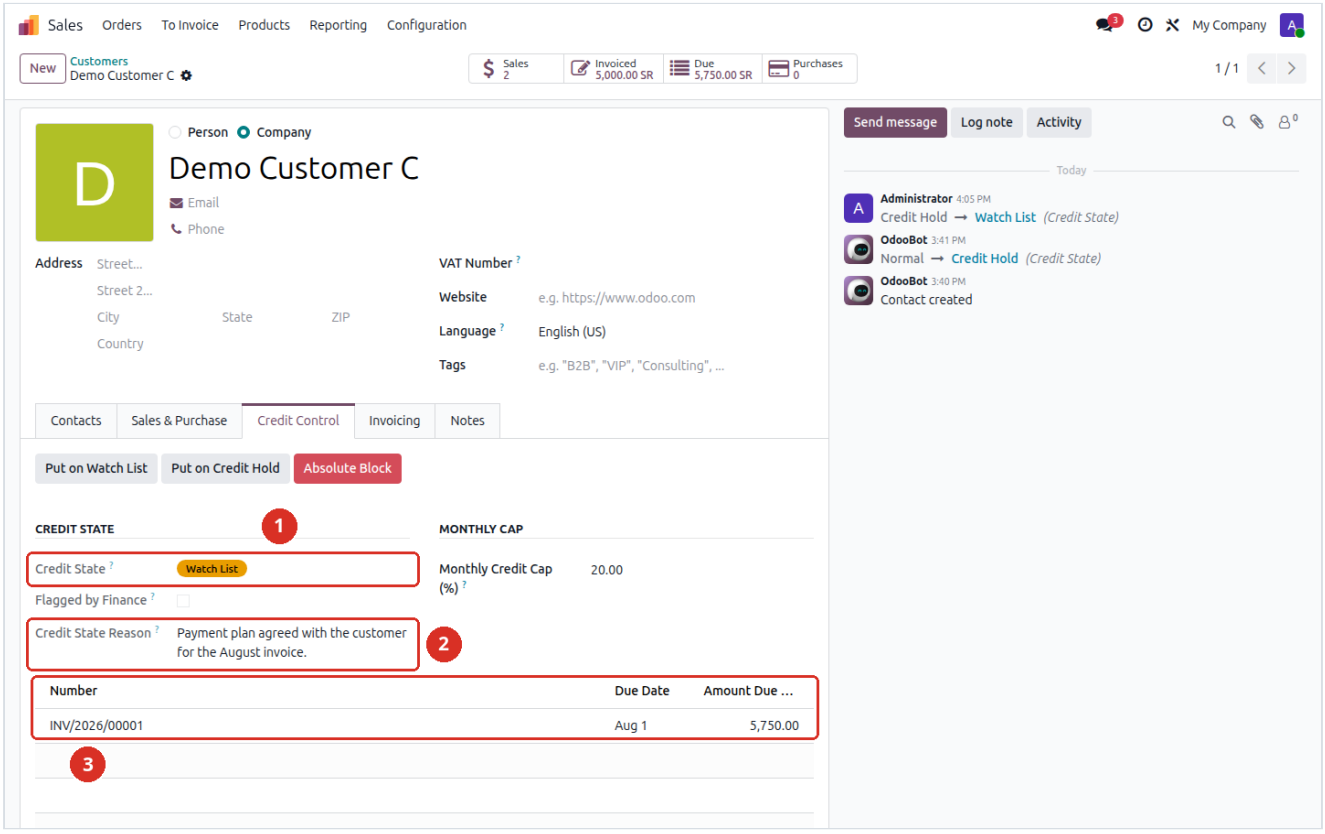
Who: Finance Manager. Where: the customer's **Credit Control** tab.

1. Click **Lift Credit Hold**. The window opens with the decision 1 set to Lift Credit Hold.
2. Type the **Reason** 2, for example the payment plan agreed.
3. Click **Confirm** 3.



Lifting a hold: decision 1, reason 2, Confirm 3.

The customer moves to **Watch List** 1 if it still has overdue invoices (otherwise to Normal). The reason is shown under **Credit State Reason** 2. The invoices that were overdue past the hold days at that moment are listed at the bottom 3: the nightly check will not put the customer back on hold for these invoices. A new invoice passing the hold days puts it on hold again. Once a listed invoice is paid, it leaves the list at the next nightly check.



After the hold is lifted: Watch List 1, the reason 2 and the invoices the decision covers 3.

Step 12: Finance flags a customer for a dispute

Who: Finance user or Finance Manager. Where: the customer's **Credit Control** tab.

Use this for a reason that is not an overdue invoice, such as an open dispute.

1. Click **Put on Watch List**.
2. Type the **Reason** and click **Confirm**.

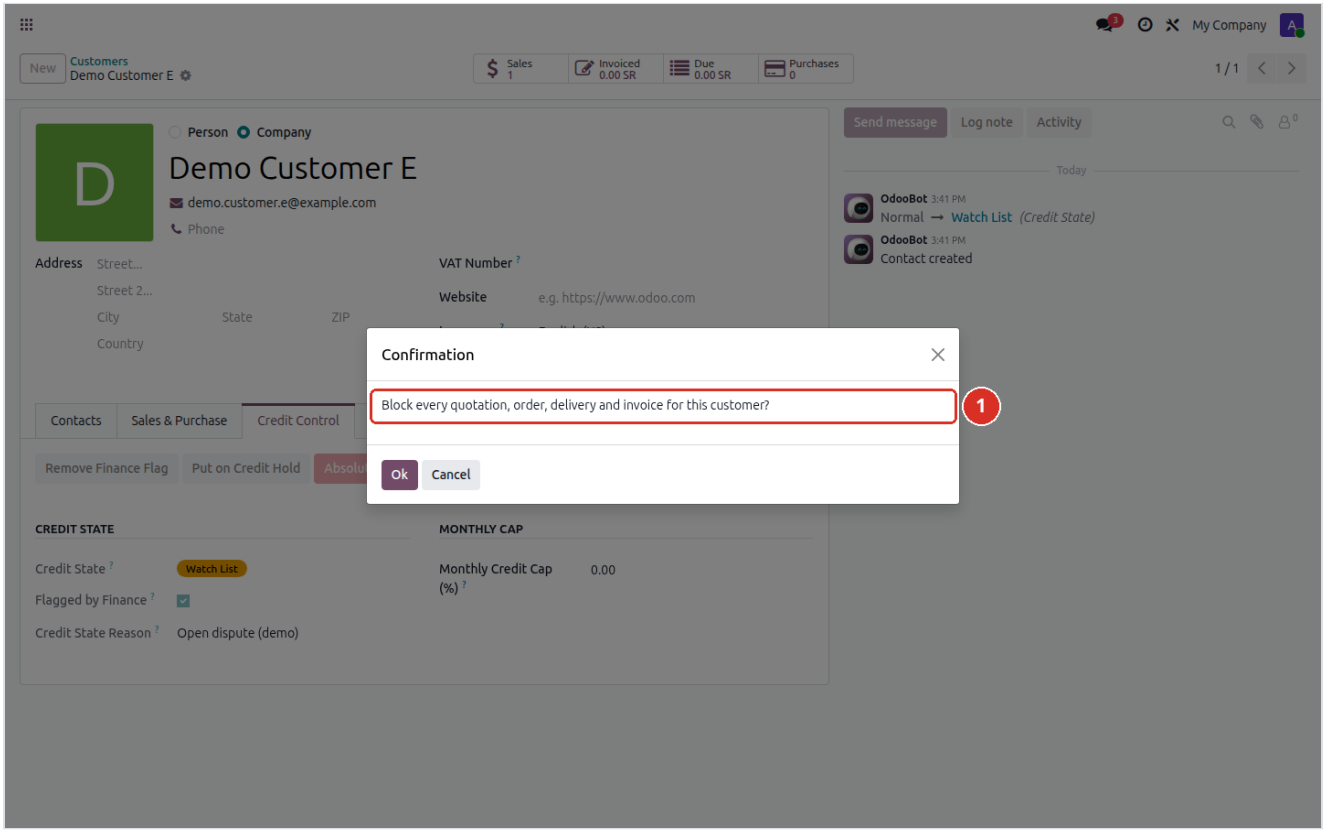
The customer goes on the watch list (if it was Normal), **Flagged by Finance** is ticked and the reason is shown. The flag keeps the customer on the watch list even when all invoices are paid, until Finance clicks **Remove Finance Flag** (also with a reason). The screens of this step are under Conditional behavior.

The watch list itself blocks nothing in this module. It is a warning for sales and Finance, and it is used by the separate Quotation Payment Terms module.

Step 13: The Finance Manager blocks a customer

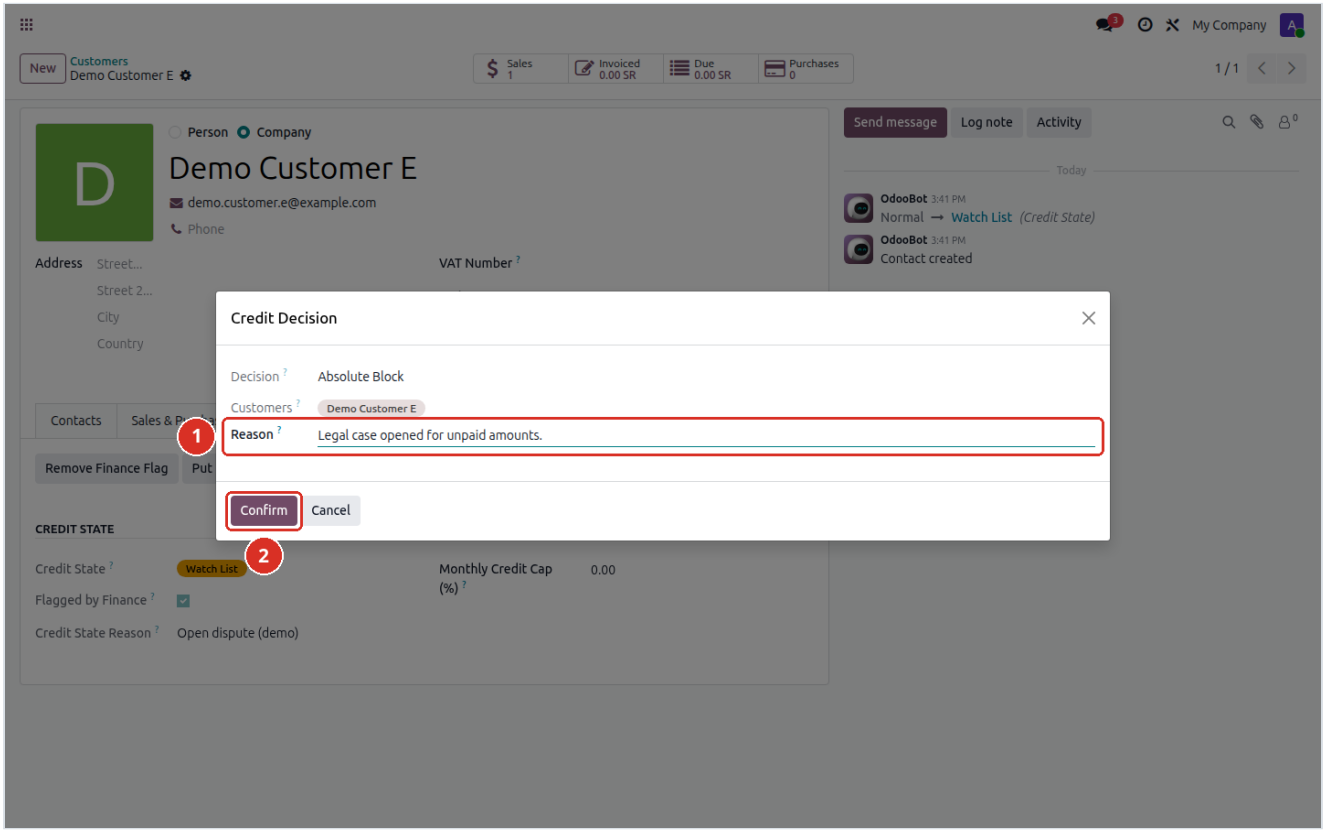
Who: Finance Manager. Where: the customer's **Credit Control** tab.

1. Click **Absolute Block**. Odoo first asks "Block every quotation, order, delivery and invoice for this customer?" 1. Click **Ok**.



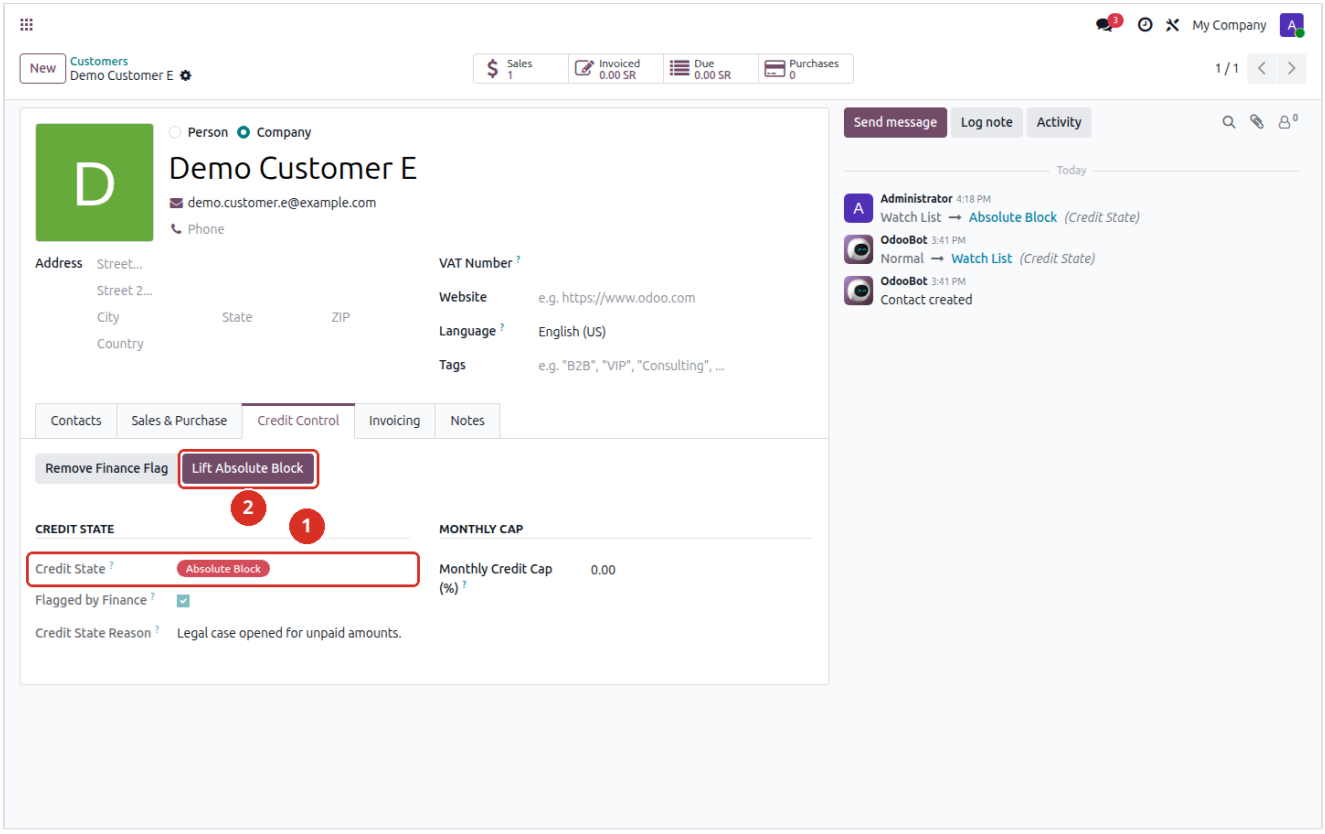
The confirmation asked before blocking 1.

1. Type the **Reason** 1 and click **Confirm** 2.



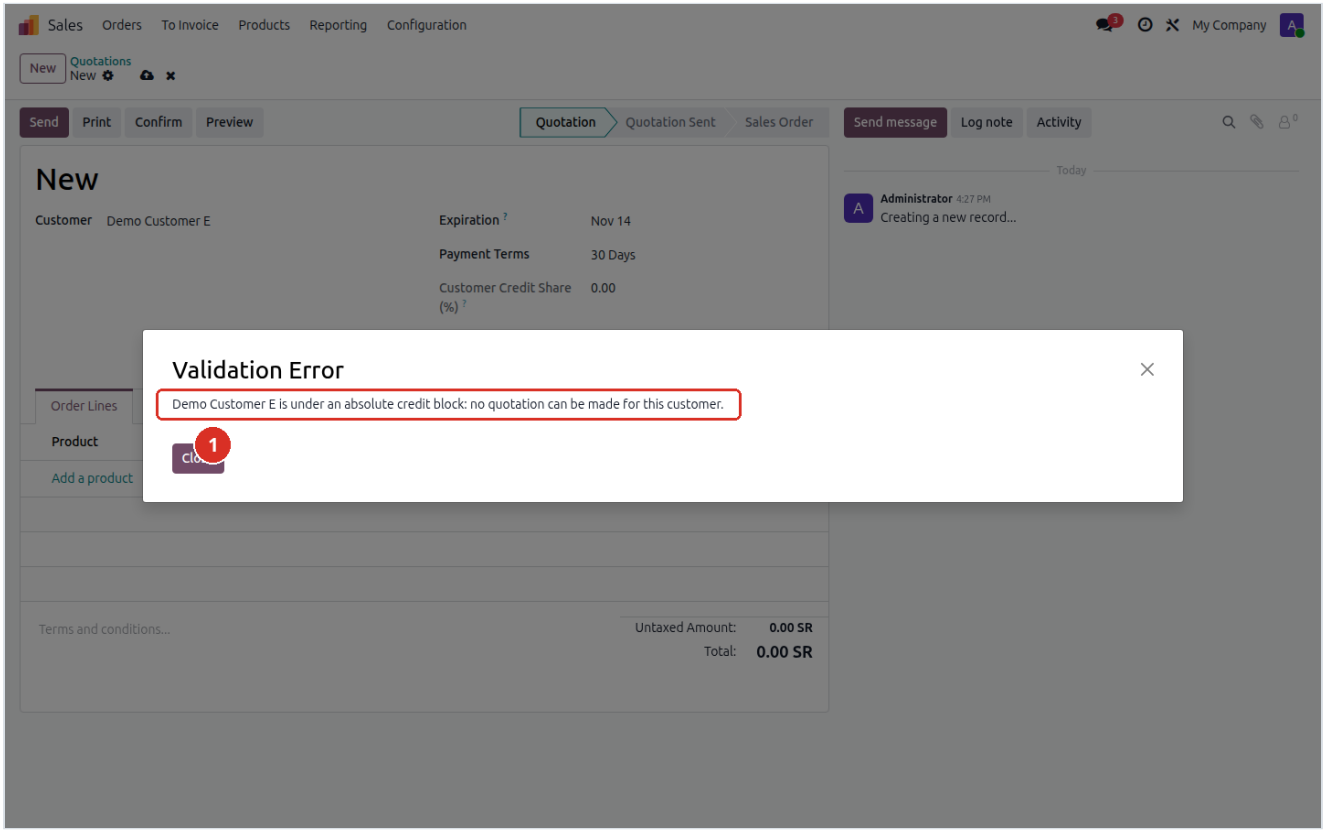
The reason for the block 1 and Confirm 2.

The customer is now under **Absolute Block** 1. Only the **Lift Absolute Block** button 2 remains, plus **Remove Finance Flag** because this customer had also been flagged by Finance. Lifting the block also needs a reason; the customer then returns to Watch List or Normal depending on its invoices and its flag.



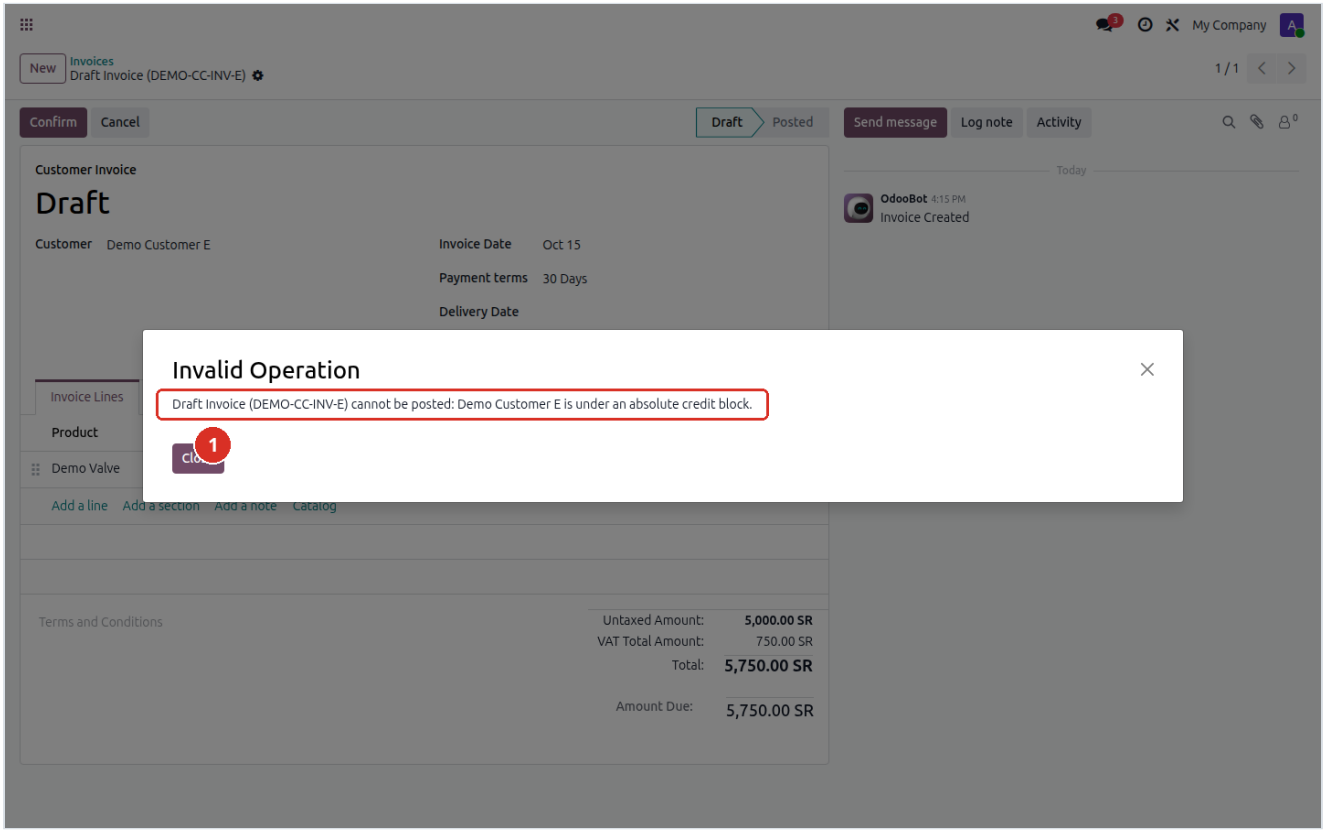
A blocked customer: the state 1 and Lift Absolute Block 2.

A blocked customer cannot receive a new quotation 1:



Saving a quotation for a blocked customer is refused 1.

and its customer invoices cannot be posted 1. Vendor bills and credit notes are not affected.

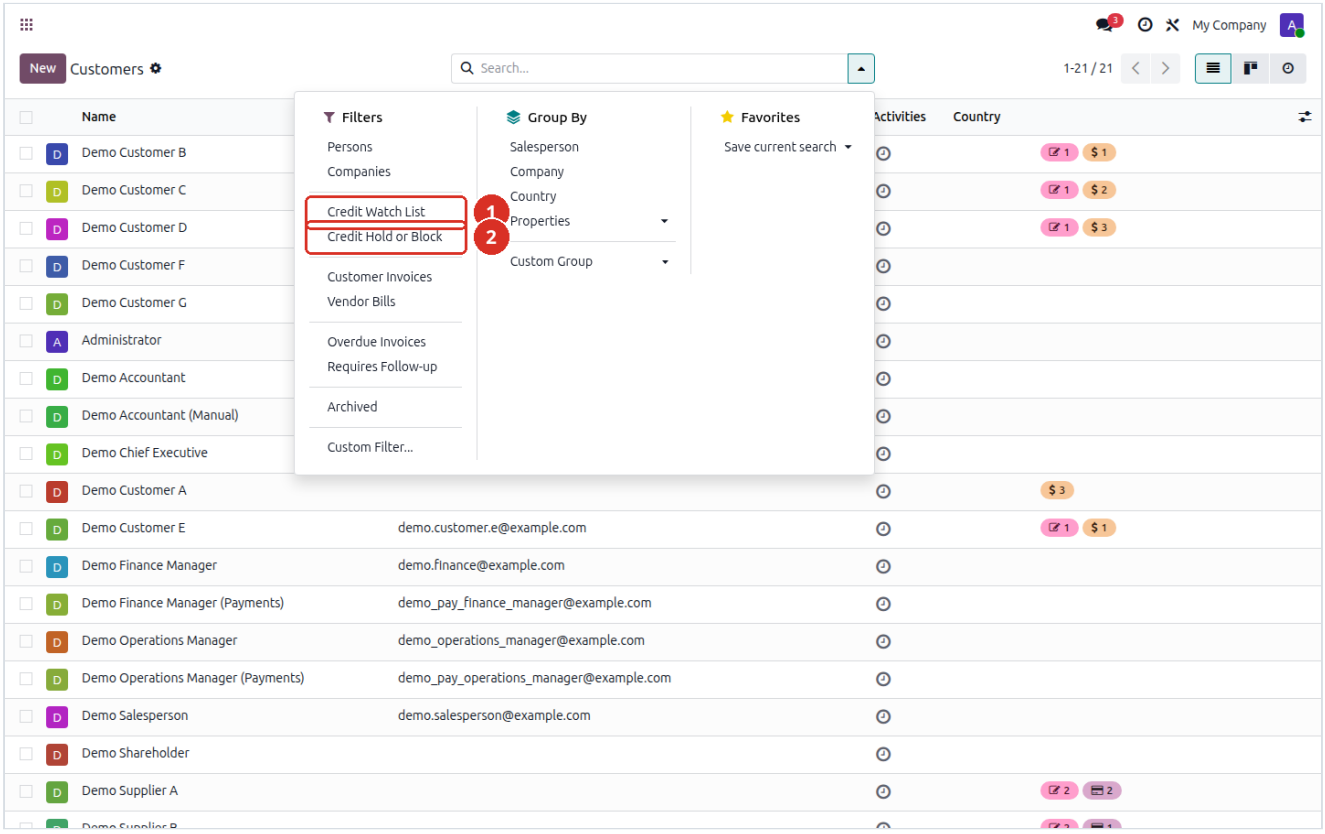


Posting a customer invoice for a blocked customer is refused 1.

Step 14: Find held and watched customers, and the weekly email

Where: **Sales › Orders › Customers**, open the search options.

Two filters 1 2 list the customers on the **Credit Watch List** and those on **Credit Hold or Block**.



The customer filters Credit Watch List 1 and Credit Hold or Block 2.

Every week, each Finance Manager who has an email address receives "Company: credit watch list, date": a table of the customers on the watch list or on credit hold that have overdue invoices, with the credit state, the overdue amount, the oldest due date and the salesperson, largest amount first. Blocked customers are not in this email. The email was produced in a test run while writing this guide; actual delivery depends on the company's outgoing mail server.

Conditional behavior

The Finance buttons depend on the credit state

The buttons on the customer's **Credit Control** tab change with the state, so only the decisions that make sense are offered:

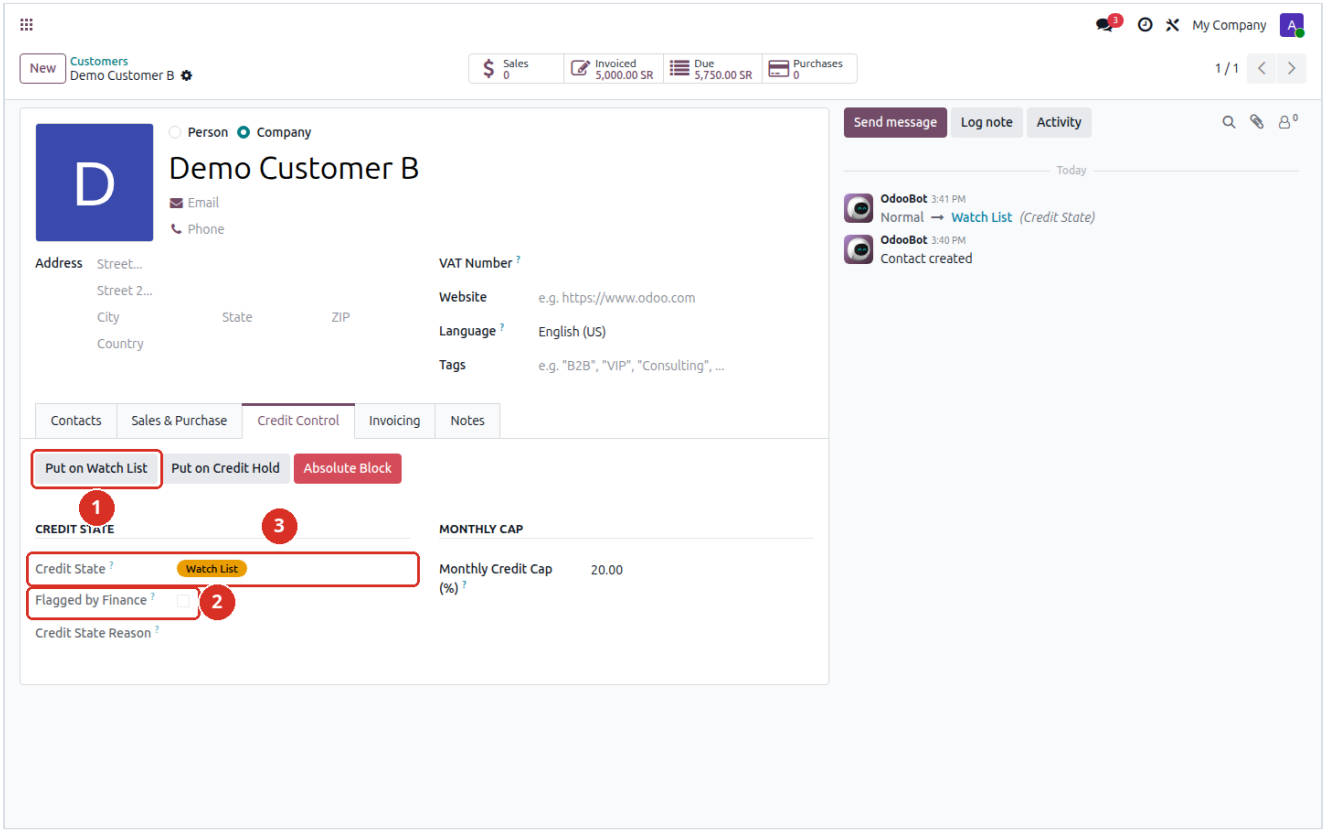
Credit state	Buttons shown
Normal or Watch List	**Put on Watch List** (unless already flagged), **Put on Credit Hold**, **Absolute Block**
Credit Hold	**Put on Watch List**, **Lift Credit Hold**, **Absolute Block**
Absolute Block	**Lift Absolute Block** only (and **Remove Finance Flag** if flagged)

Put on Watch List and **Remove Finance Flag** are shown to Finance users and Finance Managers; the other buttons only to Finance Managers. The whole tab is hidden on contact persons: credit is managed on the company they belong to.

Normal: see Step 4. Credit Hold: see Step 10. Absolute Block: see Step 13.

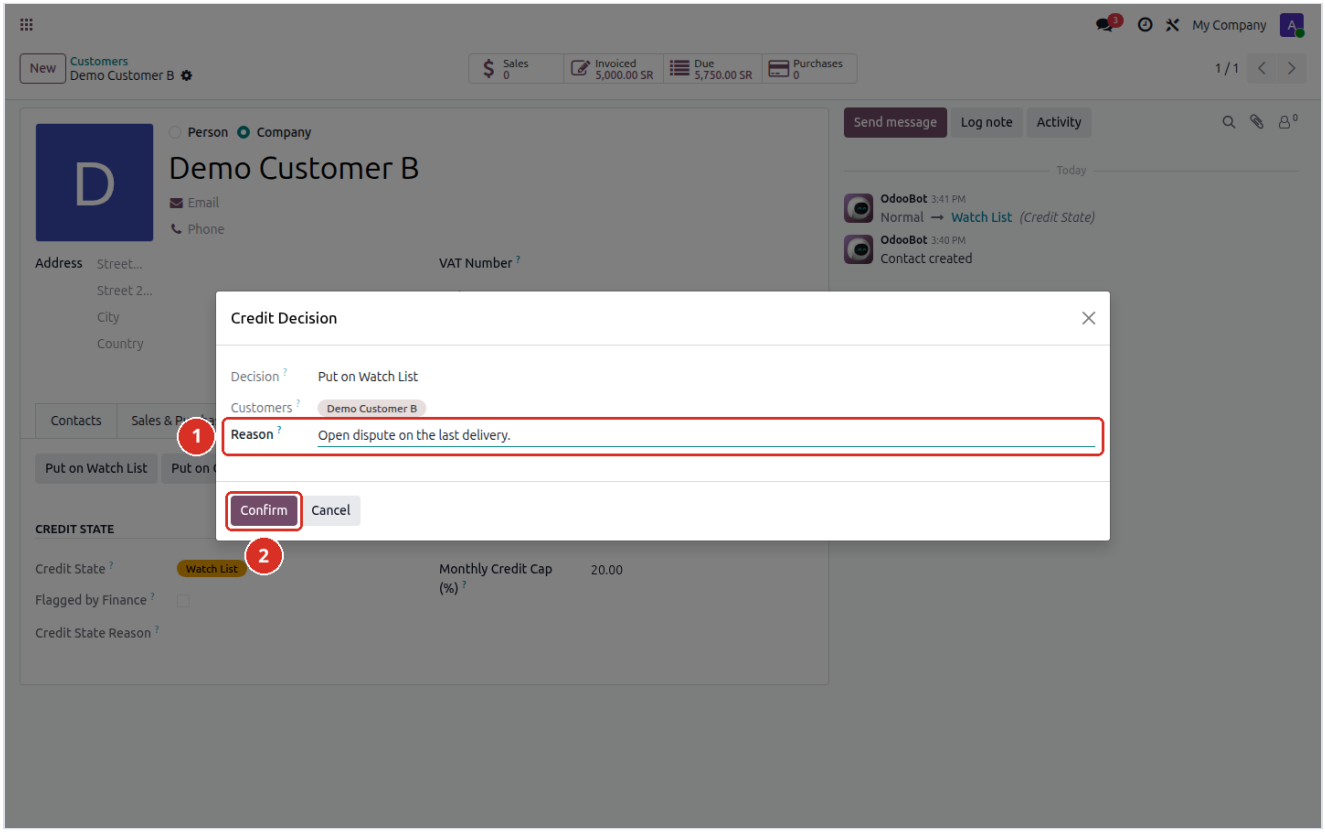
Flagged by Finance changes the watch-list buttons

When the customer is not flagged: Demo Customer B is on the watch list because of an overdue invoice. **Flagged by Finance** 2 is not ticked, and **Put on Watch List** 1 is offered.



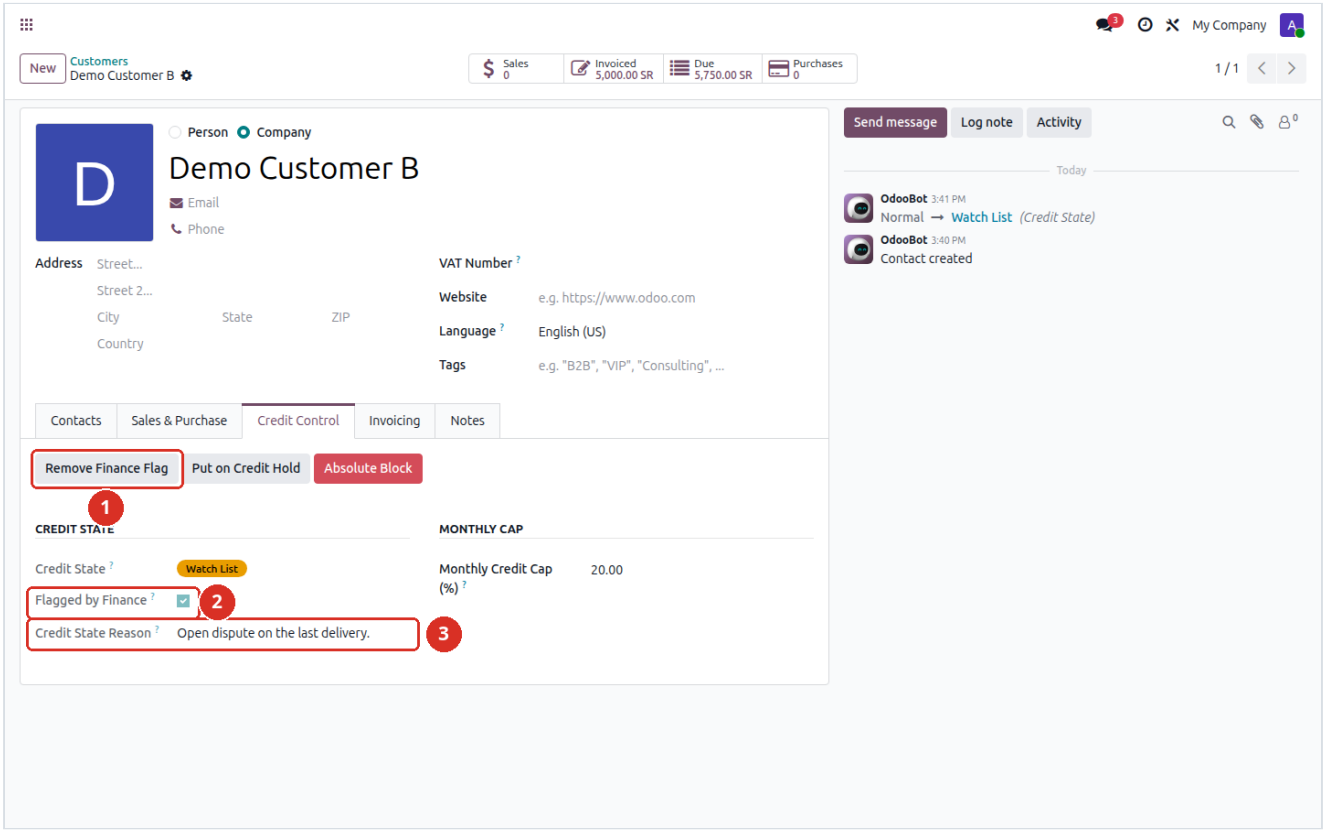
Not flagged: the Put on Watch List button 1, the Flagged by Finance box 2 and the state 3.

When Finance flags it (with a reason 1 in the window, then **Confirm** 2):



Flagging the customer: reason 1 and Confirm 2.

When the customer is flagged: Flagged by Finance 2 is ticked, the reason 3 is shown, and **Remove Finance Flag** 1 replaces **Put on Watch List**.



Flagged: the Remove Finance Flag button 1, the ticked box 2 and the reason 3.

Special Item shows Excluded from Credit Totals

When Special Item is not ticked, the **Excluded from Credit Totals** box is hidden (Step 3, first screenshot). **When it is ticked**, the box appears (Step 3, second screenshot). A product that is excluded but not special counts normally.

The order's credit fields depend on its stage

- **Customer Credit Share (%)** and **Customer Credit Cap (%)** are shown only on quotations (Step 5), not on confirmed orders.
- The red banner and the **Approve Credit** button are shown only while the order waits for approval (Step 6).
- The **Credit Approval** section of **Other Info** appears only once an order has needed approval (Step 8).

Invoices covered by a lifted hold

The list of covered invoices at the bottom of the **Credit Control** tab appears only after a hold has been lifted and while those invoices are unpaid (Step 11). It has no title on screen: it is the list of invoices the Finance Manager accepted when lifting the hold.

Troubleshooting

"S00057 waits for the Finance Manager's credit approval."

What happened: confirming the order would take the customer's credit sales of the month above its cap, or the company's above its ceiling. The order was not confirmed.

How to fix it:

1. Reload the page to see the red banner.
2. Ask the Finance Manager to open the order and click **Approve Credit** with a reason (Step 7).
3. Alternatively, reduce the order, or change it to a full advance payment term (Step 2).

"Demo Customer C is on Credit Hold: the order cannot be confirmed until the Finance Manager releases the customer."

What happened: the customer is on credit hold or under absolute block (the message names the state).

How to fix it: ask the Finance Manager to lift the hold (Step 11) or the block, with a reason. Check the customer's open invoices first: the customer usually has an invoice more than the hold days overdue.

"WH/OUT/00034 cannot be validated: Demo Customer C is on credit hold or block until the Finance Manager releases the customer."

What happened: the delivery is for a customer on credit hold or absolute block.

How to fix it: keep the goods. Ask the Finance Manager to release the customer, then validate the delivery again.

"Demo Customer E is under an absolute credit block: no quotation can be made for this customer."

What happened: you tried to save a quotation for a customer under absolute block.

How to fix it: discard the quotation. Only the Finance Manager can lift the block (Step 13).

"Draft Invoice (DEMO-CC-INV-E) cannot be posted: Demo Customer E is under an absolute credit block."

What happened: you tried to post a customer invoice for a blocked customer.

How to fix it: leave the invoice in draft until the Finance Manager lifts the block.

"Give the reason for changing the credit state." / "Give the reason for approving over the credit limit."

What happened: the **Reason** field of the Credit Decision window was empty.

How to fix it: type the reason and click **Confirm** again. Every credit decision needs one.

"Only the Finance Manager can ..." / "Only Finance can flag a customer for credit."

What happened: your user does not have the right for this decision. The exact message names the decision: approving an order over a credit limit, or changing a customer's credit state or cap.

How to fix it: the administrator gives the user Accounting / Administrator (Finance Manager) for holds, blocks, caps and approvals, or Accounting / Invoicing for the watch-list flag.

"You are not allowed to modify 'Contact' (res.partner) records."

What happened: a Finance Manager tried to save the **Monthly Credit Cap (%)** but has no right to edit contacts.

How to fix it: the administrator also gives that user the right to edit contacts (for example Contacts / Creation or Sales / Administrator). The Finance buttons are not affected; they work without this right.

"... is not on credit hold." / "... is not blocked." / "... is not waiting for credit approval."

What happened: the decision no longer applies, usually because someone else already took it.

How to fix it: reload the page and check the current state.

"The advance of a payment term is between 0 and 100%."

What happened: the advance percentage typed on a payment term is below 0 or above 100.

How to fix it: enter a value from 0 to 100.

The advance field of a payment term shows next to "Early Discount"

What happened: a display fault of the module: the **Advance (%)** field is placed inside the **Early Discount** line and has no label (Step 2).

How to fix it: nothing to fix for the user. The first number on the **Early Discount** line is the advance percentage. The fault has been reported.

What this guide does not cover

- The company ceiling of a second company: the demonstration database has only one company, so the separate ceilings per company were not shown on screen.
- The scheduled actions themselves (Settings > Technical > Automation > Scheduled Actions) were run from the server, not from the screen; their schedule (nightly and weekly) was not observed over several days.
- The weekly email was produced in a test run but was not delivered to a mailbox.